



DAS Policy

Media Protection Controls

No:
2100-17

Effective:
April 29, 2025

Approval:

Katrina Flory, Assistant Director/State CIO

I. Purpose

This policy establishes the **Media** protection requirements for establishing an effective Media protection program to manage data and information risks that are related to Media access, storage, transport, and protection. Media protection shall be based on security best practices with regard to Media usage, storage, and disposal.

The first occurrence of the word in the policy body outside of a title or heading is in bold, italic type, and is hyperlinked to the definition in Section IV. In addition, references to National Institute of Standards in Technology (NIST) Special Publication (SP) 800-53 family identifiers and control numbers are provided in parentheses next to requirement headers, where applicable.

II. Scope

All Media associated with Ohio Department of Administrative Services (**DAS-Managed System Assets**) are included in the scope of this policy.

III. Policy

DAS shall adopt a Media protection procedure to facilitate the implementation of this policy and associated Media protection controls.

- A. **Media Access (MP-2)**: Access to digital Media (e.g., disks, magnetic tapes, external/removable hard drives, flash drives) and non-digital Media (e.g., paper, microfilm), when either type of Media contains state information, shall be restricted to authorized personnel using physical access controls and safeguards.

- B. **Media Marking (MP-3):** Media containing confidential information shall be marked. The marks shall indicate the distribution limitations, handling caveats, and applicable security markings.

Removable Media containing data owned and/or provided from external sources (e.g., Internal Revenue Service, Social Security Administration, etc.) shall be marked in accordance with the applicable federal laws and regulations associated with such data.

- C. **Media Storage (MP-4):** Media containing state information shall be protected until it is destroyed or **Sanitized**, using approved equipment, techniques, and procedures, as outlined in Ohio Administrative Policy, IT-05, "Disposal, Servicing and Transfer of IT Equipment."
- D. **Media Transport (MP-5):** Media containing state data shall be protected and controlled during transport outside of controlled areas.
1. Transport of such Media shall be restricted to authorized personnel.
 2. Accountability shall be maintained for Media during transport outside of controlled areas.
 3. Cryptographic mechanisms shall be employed to protect the **Confidentiality** and **Integrity** of information on digital Media. Media protection procedures shall be in alignment with the **Confidential Data** protection requirements outlined in Ohio Administrative Policy, IT-14, "Data Encryption and Securing Confidential Data."
- E. **Media Sanitization (MP-6):** Media containing state information shall be Sanitized prior to disposal, release from organizational control, or release for reuse, as outlined in Ohio Administrative Policy, IT-05, "Disposal, Servicing, and Transfer of IT Equipment."
- F. **Media Use (MP-7):** Only state approved Media shall be used with state data and devices. Any storage of Confidential Data or **Personally Identifiable Information** on USB drives shall comply with DAS Standard DAS-ITS-700-03, "Encrypted USB Drive."

IV. Definitions

- A. **Confidential Data.** This classification includes Data that is required to be protected by law or regulation, is intended for confidential use, and may not be copied or removed from an agency's operational control without authorized permission. This classification includes Data that, if compromised, may result in loss of life, serious injury, or other harm to an individual or group, or disruption to critical agency operations.

- B. Confidentiality. Preserving authorized restrictions on information access and disclosure, including means for protecting personal privacy and proprietary information.¹
- C. DAS-Managed System Asset. Information, hardware, software and services required to support state business, and identified during the risk assessment process as assets that need to be protected. Primary responsibility for managing these system assets may be assigned to DAS OIT personnel or other outside entities.
- D. Integrity. Guarding against improper information modification or destruction, and includes ensuring information non-repudiation and authenticity.²
- E. Media. Physical devices or writing surfaces including, but not limited to, magnetic tapes, optical disks, magnetic disks, large-scale integration (LSI) memory chips, and printouts (but not including display Media) onto which information is recorded, stored, or printed within an information system.³
- F. Personally Identifiable Information (PII). “Personally identifiable information” is information that can be used directly or in combination with other information to identify a particular individual. It includes:
 - 1. a name, identifying number, symbol, or other identifier assigned to a person,
 - 2. any information that describes anything about a person,
 - 3. any information that indicates actions done by or to a person,
 - 4. any information that indicates that a person possesses certain personal characteristics.
- G. Sanitize. A general term referring to the actions taken to render data written on Media unrecoverable by both ordinary and, for some forms of sanitization, extraordinary means.⁵

V. Authority

ORC 125.18

¹ “NIST Special Publication 800-53 Revision 4, Security and Privacy Controls for Federal Information Systems and Organizations,” U.S. Department of Commerce National Institute of Standards and Technology, April, 2013 <<https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.800-53r4.pdf>>.

² “NIST Special Publication 800-53 Revision 4, Security and Privacy Controls for Federal Information Systems and Organizations,” U.S. Department of Commerce National Institute of Standards and Technology, April, 2013 <<https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.800-53r4.pdf>>.

³ *Ibid.*

⁴ Based on Ohio Revised Code Section 1347.01 (E).

⁵ “NIST Special Publication 800-53 Revision 4, Security and Privacy Controls for Federal Information Systems and Organizations,” U.S. Department of Commerce National Institute of Standards and Technology, April, 2013 <<https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.800-53r4.pdf>>.

VI. Resources

Document Name	Location
NIST Special Publication 800-53, Security and Privacy Controls for Federal Information Systems and Organizations	https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.800-53r4.pdf
NIST SP 800-88 Guidelines for Media Sanitization	https://csrc.nist.gov/publications/sp
Ohio IT Standard ITS-SEC-02 Security Controls Framework	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
Ohio Administrative Policy IT-05 Disposal, Servicing and Transfer of IT Equipment	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
Ohio Administrative Policy IT-14 Data Encryption and Securing Confidential Data	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
DAS Policy 2100-08 Risk Assessment	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
Ohio Administrative Policy AM-02 Disposal of Excess and Surplus Property	https://das.ohio.gov/buying-and-selling/policies
DAS-ITS-700-03, Encrypted USB Drive Standard	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies

VII. Inquiries

Direct inquiries about this policy to:

Office of Information Security & Privacy
Office of Information Technology
Ohio Department of Administrative Services
30 East Broad Street, 39th Floor
Columbus, Ohio 43215
614-644-6860 | state.isp@das.ohio.gov

DAS Policies may be found online at
<https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies>

VIII. Revision History

This policy shall be reviewed no less than every two years and updated as needed.

Date	Description of Change
06/18/2018	Original Policy
01/15/2020	Updated the policy template.
06/23/2021	Conducted routine maintenance review of citations and references.
03/05/2024	Updated the policy template. Added a revision history review frequency statement.
04/29/2025	Replaced the term sensitive data, or sensitive information, with confidential data. Revised references to Ohio Administrative Policy IT-14 to reflect the title change.